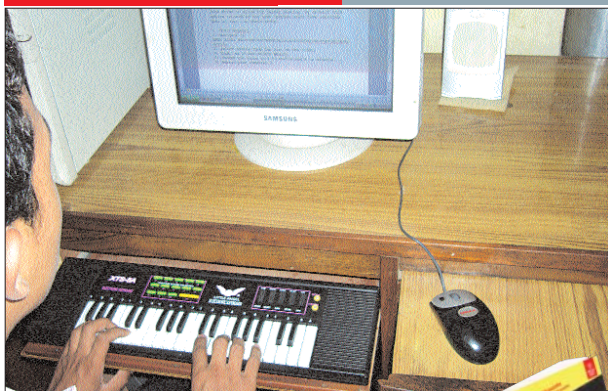


DigiPick of the month

Hmm...Maybe this
keyboard will work



This month's
winner is
Shakun Shrestha
kathmandu, Nepal

Participate and win next month
Sudoku for Dummies

by Andrew Heron and
Edmund James
Published by

WILEY-INDIA

WIN!

Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift just by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should have been shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier. E-mail your picture with the subject **'DigiPick'** and your postal address **on or before the 20th of this month to digipick@thinkdigit.com**. One prize-winning picture will be published each month.

without looking like a horror movie and so on—have showcased their VelaSmooth system to sculpt out cellulite patches from our bulging bodies. The technology? The company's eLight and eMax systems that use intense pulses of light to do their dirty work. The technology was co-created by the company's chairman Shimon Eckhouse in the 1990s to get paint off military aircraft.

In these dark, pre-VelaSmooth times, we use lasers to fry follicles off skin, a procedure that may clear hair, but may leave unsightly blemishes, thus defeating the purpose. The VelaSmooth system uses light to heat up an area of the skin, and then RF (radio frequency) to act upon that area, to avoid burning. This system doesn't really eliminate fat, rather moving it around to places where it would look better, ironing out a few wrinkles in the process as well.

The next step for Syneron is to hit upon a non-invasive

way to remove fat—dissolve it, perhaps? The catch: the dissolved fat would enter your bloodstream, leaving you about 10 minutes to enjoy the new improved you before the massive coronary hits. Better yet, let's start injecting ourselves with nano-nukes and blow the stuff up.

I SEE FRAGGED PEOPLE

Gamer Rehab Centre Opens

We have, in the past (quite callously, we must admit), taken quite a few digs at gamers who died at their desks because nobody could wrench them away from {insert game of your choice here}. Seeing as how gaming can be as addictive as crack, it's only valid that it should be treated as such. That's right—alcohol, drugs, sex—such addictions are passé

now, and we now usher in a new era of rehabilitation programs—the game-addiction rehab program.

Addiction experts Smith and Jones have, at the Wild Horses Center for addicts in Europe, started the first program for compulsive gamers to help them regain their personal hygiene, social life and the use of their legs for mundane stuff like walking. While psychologists argue that game addiction can't be put in the same class as alcohol or drug addiction, this is clearly serious stuff. According to one inmate... er... client, who for five years rarely left his room due to his addiction to MMORPGs: "I couldn't go to the toilet because then I would have to leave ... I would take an empty bottle and pee in it."

They first start with a "detox" period, where they'll deal with the withdrawal symptoms of having the game snatched away from them, following which they will fill the "adrenaline vacuum" caused by lack of gaming with real-life substitutes. Now *that* sounds like fun—imagine getting to blow up people in real life! Or smash real million-dollar cars to bits! (No, silly, that's not what they really do!)

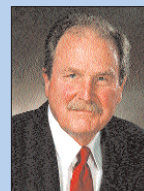
Digit's top 3 signs to tell if you're a gaming addict (issued in public interest):

1. Every time you lose, you take another stab and say, "This time, I'll win!"
2. You killed someone, but they didn't respawn and now the cops are after you
3. You don't remember the last meal you had that wasn't a medkit

People Who Changed Computing

Compression Is Key

Think data transmission and Huffman Coding is most likely at work behind the scenes. Digital life would have been very different in



David Huffman

its inventor, David A Huffman.

Huffman earned his BS in Electrical Engineering from MIT. It was during his study here that he was asked to write a paper on efficient coding techniques by his professor, Robert Fano. Fano had co-developed a compression code that came to be called the Shannon-Fano algorithm. Huffman outdid his professor when he produced his paper—his code was found to be better than the one his professor had helped develop! Today, Huffman Coding is implemented in everything from modems to JPEG and ZIP to even HDTV.

After his graduation, Huffman served in the US Navy as a radar maintenance engineer. He later earned his PhD from MIT in 1953. Awards for his innovations poured in, and the last was the Richard W Hamming Medal from the IEEE in 1999. He died the same year.

Besides coding algorithms, Huffman also made contributions in the fields of RADAR, design procedures for asynchronous logic circuits, signals, and properties of zero-curvature surfaces—which led to the concept of computational origami (which uses CAD to determine the various ways in which a material can be folded). Huffman never patented any of his ideas or research: "My products are my students," he said.